THE NOBULOUS SET · GAME TWO

Nobulous Apprenticeship Program (NAP)

A prestigious opportunity. Terms and conditions apply.

One Apprentice, three Time Slots a day, and a workload that does not care how tired you are. Earn Credits across four subjects, survive the things that go wrong, and pass a Final Exam built out of everything you neglected.

COMPONENTS

- 6 Apprentice cards
- 26 Task cards (double-sided: Request / Demand)
- 6 Setback cards
- 6 Opportunity cards
- 12 Final Exam cards (3 per subject)
- 1 Following in Nobulous' Footsteps (FINF) track card, 1 Time Slot dial
- **From 20 Strong:** the 17 unit dice — 4 Purple, 4 Blue, 4 Green, 4 Yellow, 1 Red
- **From 20 Strong:** the 3 stat dice — Health, Strategy and Recovery — and the Chip

SETUP

1. Choose an Apprentice. All six begin at **2 HP / 2 STR / 2 REC**; they differ only in abilities.
2. Shuffle 3 of the 6 Setbacks into the 26 Tasks and 6 Opportunities to form the Assignment deck. Return the other 3 Setbacks to the box.
3. Set the FINF track to **−1** (Standard difficulty).
4. Separate the 12 Final Exams. You will build the exam pool later.
5. Take all 17 dice as available. Set the Time Slot dial to Morning, Day 1.

OBJECT OF THE GAME

Earn **6 Credits** to reach the Final Exam, then survive three exams with at least 1 Health remaining. Credits are earned by completing Credit Tasks and are never spent — a completed Task stays face-up as the record of that subject.

HOW THE APPRENTICESHIP ENDS

Play Days until **either** you hold 6 Credits **or** the Assignment deck runs out. Both send you to the Final Exam; arriving short of 6 Credits just costs you dice (see *Leaving the apprenticeship*). **If your Health ever reaches 0 you lose immediately** — during the apprenticeship or during the exams.

THE DAY

Each day has three Time Slots: **Morning**, **Afternoon**, **Evening**. Each slot runs:

1. Perform the recovery shown on the dial for this slot. (Day 1 Morning has no special recovery.)
2. Reveal 2 Assignments and take one into the row as your **Primary**. **Discard the other.** A Setback among the two **must** be the one you take. The Primary's recovery-colour dot sets the colour queued for the next Time Slot.
3. Work Assignments with Strategy rolls.
4. Flip every Assignment still unresolved (below), exhaust non-stored committed dice, perform **Special Recovery**, then normal recovery by REC. Set the dial to the Primary's dot and advance.

After Evening, resolve End of Day.

The row is **the same row all game**: Assignments you do not clear stay on the table and follow you into the next Time Slot. A slot holds a maximum of **4** Assignments — if the row is already full when you reveal, discard both revealed cards and take nothing.

SPECIAL RECOVERY

Recover **all** exhausted dice of the queued recovery colour. Then recover dice equal to your REC separately.

STR in NAP

STR does two jobs and resets every Time Slot. It is the number of Strategy rolls available in the slot, *and* the

maximum number of Assignments you may complete in that slot — even if more have enough successes on them.

WORKING ASSIGNMENTS

- You may spread dice across as many Assignments as you like during a roll.
- **Required Effort.** Every roll must be a real attempt: choose at least one Assignment — a Setback if one is present — and commit either one die matching that Assignment's colour dot, Red, or at least two dice of another colour. Empty rolls are illegal. **Waive this only if no legal commitment is possible at all.**
- To **complete an Assignment or store progress on it**, the successes you apply must include a successful die matching its colour dot, Red as wild, or two successful dice of the same other colour. The colour rule governs storing as well as finishing — you cannot bank progress with dice that could never have counted.
- You may spend 1 STR to remove the initial Assignment without gaining its benefit.

Unresolved Assignments

- Successful dice on an unresolved Assignment may be **stored as progress** instead of exhausted.
- **At the end of the Time Slot**, every Assignment in the row that is still unresolved flips to its **Demand** side — higher Target. Flipping costs nothing by itself.
- An Assignment that is *already* on its Demand side and still unresolved at the end of a slot **inflicts its printed Demand penalty**, and does so again at the end of every slot it survives.
- Once the next Time Slot begins, stored dice are locked to that Assignment and cannot be voluntarily exhausted.
- When an Assignment finally resolves, its committed and stored dice exhaust unless the card says otherwise. A Credit Task completed on its **Demand** side still earns its Credit.
- Opportunity effects that reach into the next Time Slot override restrictions printed on the Task cards they apply to.

Assignment types

TYPE	ROLE
Task	The only source of Credits.
Setback	Mandatory and disruptive. No Credits.
Opportunity	Optional and beneficial. No Credits, no penalties.

> **SKULLS**
>
> Skulls resolve only on Assignments *you chose*. Ignore Skulls on cards added by another Skull, by FINF, or by a forced replacement. If a Skull would add an Assignment while the slot already holds 4, do not add a card — instead rotate the Skull-generating Assignment to its Demand side once. Further blocked Skulls do nothing.

FOLLOWING IN NOBULOUS' FOOTSTEPS (FINF)

FINF is the difficulty dial, and it works in two directions. **Choose one setting before you start** and use the card at that setting for the whole game. Standard difficulty is **−1**.

Increase — +1 / +2 / +3

Shuffle the FINF card into the Assignment deck. When it is drawn, place it *before* the Primary selection for that slot, then add Assignments from the top of the deck:

- **+1** adds 1 Assignment to the next Time Slot.
- **+2** adds 1 to each of the next 2 Time Slots.
- **+3** adds 1 to each of the next 3 Time Slots.

Ignore Skulls on Assignments added by FINF, and never exceed 4 Assignments in a row.

Reduce — −1 / −2 / −3

The setting is the number of **uses you have for the whole game**: −1 gives one use, −3 gives three. Rotate the card after each use. One use lets you **remove any non-Final-Exam Assignment from the current row** and exhaust every die stored on it.

FINF is not used during the Final Exam, in either direction.

END OF DAY

Reveal and discard the top card of the Assignment deck. Ignore all of its text, effects and Skulls.

THE FINAL EXAM

Leaving the apprenticeship

Discard unresolved Assignments and exhaust their stored dice. If you have fewer than 6 Credits, exhaust 1 available die per missing Credit in the order Red, Purple, Blue, Green, Yellow, looping as needed.

Preparation

- Recover 1 exhausted die.
- Recover 1 further exhausted die per Credit *above* 6. Excess-Credit recovery may not pick the same colour twice.
- Perform the queued Morning recovery.

Building the exam pool

For each subject independently, place cards from that subject into the pool:

CREDITS IN SUBJECT	CARDS PLACED
0–1	1
2–3	2
4+	3

Shuffle the pool and draw **3** Final Exams.

Resolving the exams

1. Reduce the exam's base Target by 1 for each Credit you hold in that subject.
2. Roll against the modified Target, honouring the exam's printed restriction.
3. **Lose 1 Health for each success below the modified Target.** If you still have Health, you passed.
4. Perform Special Recovery using that exam card's own colour dot, then resolve the next exam.

All three exams are mandatory. FINF is not used during the Final Exam. Finish all three with at least 1 Health to win NAP.

CARRYING NAP FORWARD

Only relevant if you are playing the Nobulous Research Journal (NRJ) campaign.

The **3 Final Exams you actually faced** are retained. Three unused Final Exams become candidates. NAP contributes 6 cards to the Research Pool.